

SIR OTONDE MICHAEL- FOR CONGRESS

EFN 402/412 NOTES

Scope and purpose of Comparative Education

- i. Subject matter and Content
- ii. Geographical units of study
- iii. Ideological scope
- iv. Thematic scope
- v. The historical/spatial scope

Purpose

1. Provide a picture of education systems in various parts of the world.
2. To enable one come up with a global description and classification of education in various parts of the world
3. To determine the relations and aspects in education and society e.g.
 - ❖ How does family size affect education?
 - ❖ How does social status affect education?
 - ❖ What are the motivations of different social classes to participate in education?
4. To distinguish the fundamental elements of educational persistence and change and relate them to philosophical laws.
5. To facilitate practical reforms and plan for development of the school system i.e the improvement of education at home. This can be achieved by establishing the co-relation of aims, customs, social norms and the education system.
6. To enable one have a greater understanding of the wider educational process.
7. To promote the spirit of international understanding and cooperation of those who study it by promoting friendship through understanding other people's point of view and understanding other people's culture.

Rationale of studying Comparative Education

- i. Description and understanding of education systems in home and foreign countries.
- ii. Evaluation of education systems to find out whether the national objectives are being achieved.
- iii. Use of intellectual reasoning and application in the education system.
- iv. In the planning process of the institutions and education system in the country.

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- v. In improving the education system by making it more practical.
- vi. Improving the education by ensuring that humanitarian viewpoints are considered.
- vii. Understanding of educational problems in world and regional perspectives. viii. Introduction of innovations in education processes.
- ix. Understanding the economics of education in the provision of education in their institutions and countries.
- x. Relaxing the national pride by appreciating other education systems and cultures through international understanding.

Development of Comparative Education

Four main phases in the historical development of Comparative Education

1. The phase of traveler's tales- from antiquity (ancient times to the end of 18th Century)
2. The phase of Selective borrowing/pioneers: during the 19th Century.
3. The phase of concern for cultural context: from 1900 to the end of WW2 in the 1945.
4. The phase of social science perspective: from the end of WW2 in 1945 to present.

The phase of Travelers' Tales (From early times to the end of the 18th Century.

A. Background

Visitations to other countries- whether for the purposes of commerce, conversations, curiosity or conflict – dates back to ancient history of mankind.

From one point of view, everyone who has ever been interested in the upbringing of children, or in education generally, has tended to inquire into what went on in other communities and has reported back.

By reading about early writers of CE, we note that they draw examples from societies other their own.

They normally look for similarities and differences in the education of other communities and their own.

B. Motivation and Characteristic activities of the phase of the Phase of Travelers'

Tales:

- The main motives were curiosity and the need for comparison **Characteristics** ○ Travelers give descriptive accounts of their journeys and experiences in foreign lands
 - They gave descriptive accounts of features in foreign systems of education as they saw them.
 - However, their attention to education was fragmented and generally unsystematic.
 - They included exaggerations and understatements. ○ However, although they were stimulating, they were superficial(shallow) and piecemeal.

Contribution to the Development of CE

I. By Individuals

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Xenophone(C 430-355 BC)

He was a Greek, described the training of Persian youths for citizenship and leadership.

He compared the aims and structure of Persian and Greek education systems especially Sparta, which he admired and wished Athens would copy.

He commented on the relationship between education and social occupation status in the two countries.

He also gave a detailed account of the education of the Persians in his bibliography of King Cyrus.

Plato

- In his two books: The Republic and The Law he compared systems of Education in Sparta and Athens
- He urged that the Athens education system should borrow from the Spartan education in aspects of discipline. **Cicero**
- He was a Roman who made comparisons between Greek and Roman education in his book De-Republica(C.,57BC)
- He advocated for the state controlled system as opposed to a family centred system.
- In his De Oratore Cicero claimed that Greece was far better than every nation in the practice of eloquence

Julius Caesar (C. 102-42 BC)

In his writing on the Gallic Wars he commented on education of Belgians, Aquitanians and Celts **Others**

- ✓ Tacitus(AD 55-116)
- ✓ Ibn Khaldun (133-1460)
- ✓ Erasmus (1496-1536)
- ✓ Montaigne(1533-1592)
- ✓ William Petty(1623-1687)

II. Contribution by Learning Institutions

Particularly university- type institutions of higher learning during the period after Renaissance and Reformation in Europe.

Relevance of the Phase of Travelers' Tales to present day theory and practice

- Features of travelers' tales still remain with us in the work of journalists and trippers.
- Indeed their reports are informal getting to know the experience of other societies.

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- They form the first step in understanding the education in other countries.
- Stories given on return from visits to other countries add flavor to our teaching in schools.
- Eye witness accounts are still valuable in research.
- Novels and stories about other countries are all commendable in our present day educational practices.

The phase of Selective Education Borrowing: During the 19th Century/Pioneers A. Background

The 19th Century Europe was characterized by the aftermath of the French Revolution, industrial revolution, agrarian Revolution, and the process of colonization.

- Most education reformers of the time were disturbed by the social and political conditions of revolutions and reactions of the early 19th Century Europe.
- In education they saw the means of moral improvement and social amelioration.
- Reformers were concerned that the ability of individual school systems to improve themselves seemed limited even where there were good intentions.
- There was need to share the best ideas and practices available in many countries.
- This presented a significant change of approach, suggesting a more systematic and comprehensive collection of data and 'selective borrowing' in education.

B. Motivation and character activities of the Phase of Selective Education Borrowing Motivations

Selective borrowing in Education was motivated by:

- i. Efforts to develop a methodology –or a system of rules to be followed in studying foreign systems of education.
- ii. A drive to learn lessons from foreign systems of education for the purpose of borrowing ideas. **Characteristic Features**
 - The 19th C period saw journeys to foreign countries by travelers with specialized interests in education matters.
 - There were serious attempts at general observation and study of other systems of education.
 - The travelers no longer travelled for general curiosity and enlightenment rather
 - They wanted to discover what was going on in education in other countries in order to borrow aspects for improvement of their own systems of Education.

C. Contribution to development of CE during the Phase of Selective

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Borrowing in the 19th C (I) Contribution by Individuals Marc Antoine Jullien de Paris (1775-1848)

This period is considered as the starting point of CE which is associated with Marc Antoine Jullien de Paris work plan and preliminary views for work of Comparative Education.

- ❖ He lived in France during the time of Napoleonic wars
- ❖ He was disturbed by the social and political conditions of revolution in the early 19th C. Europe
- ❖ He saw education as a positive science which could be utilized to improve the French society through a systematic and rigorous approach of comparative analysis.
- ❖ In his book plan he gave a comprehensive scheme for comparative study of foreign systems of education.
- ❖ The purpose of his visits to other countries was to use foreign examples to stimulate the French system of education.

Victor Cousin (1792-1867)- France

- He lived at a time when Europe was in chaos after Napoleonic wars- hence there was need to bring reform in France.
- A professor of philosophy and head of France's Normal school, he visited Prussia where he investigated its education with the aim of finding out areas of relevance for the reform of education in his country.
- In his report (1813), Cousin recommended selective education borrowing from Russian experience.
- According to him, rivalries and antipathies would be out of place.
- People of stature should not be afraid to learn from wherever and whatever is appropriate.

Horace Mann (1796-1859)

- ✚ In America, he visited Prussia, Scotland, Ireland, France, Germany, Holland and England.
- ✚ Experience in these countries led him to conclude that history provided an explanation for the conditions which he saw.
- ✚ He saw the role history in CE studies as that of illuminating present problems.
- ✚ He argued that many features of Prussian education could be useful in America despite the gulf he saw between political and social ideals of the two societies.

Henry Barnard (1811-1900)

- In America he visited Europe and like Mann, he was impressed by the Prussian ideas on education.

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- He founded the Connecticut Common School Journal that contained many of his reports and details of foreign systems of education.
- Between 1856- 1881, he published a journal titled 'The American Journal of Education'
- He presented statistical material from various educational systems in his publications as well as historical and descriptive data of Comparative kind.

Others are:

- Mathew Arnold(1822-1888)
- KD Ushinsky(1824-1870)

(II) Contributions by Agencies

- Apart from the increase in the incidence of trips to other countries in search of improvements for home systems of education the 19th C noteworthy for the establishment of national agencies for collection and dissemination of information about systems of education. E.g.
 - United States office of Education (1870)
 - The Musee Pedagogue in Paris (1879)
 - The office of special Inquiries and Reports in London (1895)

(C) Relevance of the Phase of Selective Borrowing to present day theory and

Practice of education.

- The motivation and activities of selective borrowing have relevance to present day theory and practice of education.
- They were mainly descriptive and utilitarian in purpose.
- Descriptive studies are features still relevant in education today.
- We all endeavor to make education utilitarian
- We still visit other countries/ institutions bench marking for the purpose of observing what may be of value to be brought and used at home.
- There is the importance of learning from the experiences of others in order to improve institutions in our systems of education.

Phase of the *social sciences perspective*:

From the end of World War II in 1945 to present

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(i) Background

□ The phase has been characterized by many **forces**:

- ✚ the explosion of *aspirations*; explosion of *population*; explosion of *knowledge*, particularly in the area of *science* and *technology*;
- ✚ urbanization as a result of industrialization; population explosion due to
- ✚ developments in the science of medicine; a drive for peace to facilitate
- ✚ material, moral and spiritual reconstruction; Efforts to:
 - remove suspicion and distrust among nations;
 - promote goodwill and co-operation among nations;
 - democratize education;
 - diversify education to serve and suit diversified societies or communities;
 - provide quality education for the purpose of progress.

□ Consequently, there has been the creation of **international organizations**, such as the UNESCO, UNICEF; WHO UNEP etc designed to facilitate the promotion of human welfare, reconstruction, diversification, improvement of education, and management of knowledge.

(6 marks)

(ii) Motivations

The phase of **the social sciences perspective** has been motivated by the need for:

- Refining of methodology in comparative education.
- **Study** and **teaching** of comparative education as a discipline in institutions of learning within systems of education — particularly in institutions of higher education. □ Establishment of comparative education centers for research and teaching.
- Acceptance of the notion that it is not sufficient merely to provide information, and to say: "this is how education is organized in Kenya, Uganda, Tanzania, Zambia, Britain, France, the USA, Japan, etc", or to simply collect facts. Hence the need:
 - to organize the facts collected.
 - to interpret the collected facts.
 - to change the collection into systems;
 - to offer explanations and theories regarding the collected data.
 - to identify the best method of conducting studies in comparative education.
- So far no one method has been identified.
Hence the need for:
Debate on methodology in comparative education to continue;
- The development of the social sciences and the invention of the computer have carried those working in the field of comparative education closer to their goal.

(4 marks)

(iii) Major activities characteristic of the phase

Since the end of World War II in 1945, there has been:

- Less concern for analysis of antecedents and more emphasis on contemporary relationships.

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- Less historical and more quantitative and empirical modes for analysis, drawing on techniques and conceptual frameworks of sociology, economics, political science, etc.
- Debates in an effort to identify the best method of conducting comparative education studies so as to yield the most valid data, information and advice.

Comparative educationists have been working with educational systems and international organizations providing information, data and advice when required. In their work, they have been concerned with the most appropriate methods of generating relevant data, which is necessary if they have to give sound advice to various states and international bodies.

(iv) Contribution to the phase.

A new generation of scholars emerged after World War II. When faced with the problem of educational reforms, this new generation of administrators and scholars took a new interest in comparative education. The aims of comparative education have remained as before. But:

- New approaches have been developed:
 - some workers still use primarily the historians' mode of analysis;
 - others employ philosophical techniques,
 - a third group rely on sociological methods of inquiry;
 - more recently psychologists and economists have entered the field and are using their research techniques.
- There is, however, increasing emphasis on, and the need for, inter-disciplinary methods of inquiry with social scientists collaborating with comparative educationists to analyze common problems and examine various national solutions with the intention of increasing theoretical insight and promoting reform.
- Among the many individuals who have contributed to the phase of *Social Science Perspectives* in the development of comparative education since 1945 are: Vernon Mallinson, Joseph A. Lauwerys, George Z.F. Bereday, Brian Holmes, and Edmund J. King etc.

Determinants of Systems of Education

Geographical

- i. Geography of a place dictates the nature of buildings/equipment, school transport etc
 - ii. School going age of children
 - iii. Training of medical personnel on prevalent disease i.e. tropical diseases in Africa
 - iv. Class timetables in hot and cold areas
 - v. Distance to schools determine whether boarding/day.
 - vi. Land configuration determines architectural structures.
 - vii. Population density affects distribution of schools
- Religious

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- i. Determines aims, content and even methodology used in schools
- ii. Religious subjects are offered in schools
- iii. Missionaries established schools in potential areas and neglected marginal areas iv. Religion determined school days i.e. Monday-Friday, but resting over weekends
- v. Religious organizations are sponsors of some schools.

Economic Factors.

- ✓ The type of education of a country is largely shaped by its economic strength.
- ✓ The level and rate of economic development of a country, largely determines the decline or advancement of education in various ways.
- ✓ This factor determines the content and method of an education system.
- ✓ In African Indigenous Education, people were trained depending on the economic conditions and needs of the community.
- ✓ If the economic condition is poor, education becomes backward while if it is strong, then educational aims and the curriculum are given a special direction for making the country prosperous.
- ✓ The economy of a country determines the amount or percentage of revenue spent on education.
- ✓ In Developed countries education system is patterned to make the individual graduate, strong and capable enough to stand on his or her own feet after having received education.
- ✓ Such countries afford to provide free education to all & compulsory, UPE. Even secondary education is free.
- ✓ The newly industrialized countries have middle levels of income such as Thailand, Singapore, Malaysia, Indonesia, Taiwan and South Korea. UPE is nearly achieved.
- ✓ In developed and newly developed countries, there are strict prohibitions of nonenrolments, school dropouts and low completion rates - parents of pupils who do not enrol are charged accordingly in law courts.
- ✓ The economy of a country determines the amount or percentage of revenue spent on education.
- ✓ Where the economy of a country is high, there are enough grants, minimum requirements per student are met hence the quality of education is high.
- ✓ On the other hand, the poorer classes in communities tend to be content with minimum education for their children richer classes are known to be able to keep their children longest at school because they can afford to meet the costs.
- ✓ The quality of education is low. The teachers are not qualified, resource materials such as books are not enough and in insufficient amounts.
- ✓ Economic factors determine the amount of support of educational programmes in the education systems.
- ✓ In developing countries such as Kenya, where funds are very scarce, it affects even payment of teachers' salaries

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Systems of Education China

The students should discuss aspects that are aligned but no limited to i) Education system policy ii) Education system administration, iii) Structure for teaching (Levels of Education), iv) Support services, v) Financing of Education, vi) Teacher Education, vi) Adult Education and vii) Higher Education.

- China is the largest education system in the world, its Investment in education accounts for about 4% of total GDP
- In 1986, the Chinese government passed a compulsory education law, making nine years of education mandatory for all Chinese children.
- 9 yr compulsory education policy enables students over six years nationwide to have free education at both primary schools (grade 1 to 6) and junior secondary schools (grade 7 to 9).
- Chinese early age programs exist in three forms, nurseries, kindergartens that offer preprimary programs for children below 6
- **Nursery schools.** These schools are characterized by small groups with a lot of attendants, including trained nurses that give constant care to the children. □ Physical care and development are the main characteristics of the schools.
- KG schools range from government schools, private government-licensed schools and work based school units that are government-operated comprehensive communities - workers and their families work and live. Usually around a college or factory
- To enhance the management and guidance of kindergartens, the state has formulated regulations including "Regulations on The Management of Kindergartens" and the "Regulations on Kindergarten Work" placing the management of kindergartens on scientifically sound and institutionalized basis.
- The state has also formulated regulations and rules concerning the qualification of kindergarten teachers and their performance
- **At primary school,** The content of the curriculum relates to their daily experience, social development and technological innovation. Based on the four pillars of learning i.e “learning to know, learning to do, learning to live together and learning to be.”
- Entry to university depends primarily on how well the students perform in the entrance examinations.

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- Students with outstanding academic performance in their secondary schools can also possibly be granted an exemption from the entrance examination and be recommended directly to the University of their Choice through a method called (baosong).
- Prestigious universities (key institutions) maintain higher admission standards, and therefore require higher scores than other institutions.
- Entry to higher education in China is highly competitive
- Teacher education: China has a consistent teacher development system.
- Teaching has historically been & remains a highly respected profession in China.
- Teachers have strong preparation in their subject matter, prospective teachers spend a great deal of time observing the classrooms of experienced teachers, in schools attached to their universities.
- Once teachers are employed in school, there is a system of induction and continuous professional development in which groups of teachers work together with master teachers on lesson plans and improvement.
- **Effect of One Child Policy** - given parents an extremely great interest in the education of their young children. Education regarded as a family investment.
- **Chinese parental involvement** - Chinese parents have a much greater educational bond with their children's education and much higher expectations for their children
- **The teacher's role** - China has a dependable teacher training system. Teachers have a strong grounding in their area of expertise and spend time observing the classrooms of other experienced instructors, often in schools attached to their universities.
- **Administration:** Kindergartens and primary schools are usually run by local education authorities and private enterprises. Higher Education and is controlled directly by the government
- **Financing:** Education is centralized thus financed by the Ministry of Education.
- **The ministry of education supervises**, implements and regulates all aspects of the education system **U.S.A.**
- The USA has a population of about 300 million people.
- It has about 95% enrolment in primary school, about 90% enrolment in secondary school and 83% in tertiary education.
- Government spending on education stands at 15.3%. After the collapse of the former USSR, the USA has remained the major super power in the contemporary world.
- Education has played a significant role in the rise of the USA to be the world's major economic and technological power. This advancement gives the USA a dominant position on most global issues
- The Educational philosophy of American education was largely an offshoot of European education especially influenced by the views of Herbert Spencer. Special emphasis was placed on the sciences. USA leads in opening up the education system to most of its people

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and would like to be the first in the world in Mathematics and Science achievement. The overall theory or philosophy is pragmatism and is based on problem solving.

Aims of Education

The aims of education have been under constant revision over the years. However, the general aim of education in U.S.A is to prepare the youth to fit in the political belief of the country. The country espouses propagation of freedom, equality, democracy and independence and these are all engrained in her education system.

Structure

□ Variations exist between different states in the way their schools are structured.

However, there are common characteristics' pre-elementary, elementary, Junior high school, Senior high school, Junior college, Senior college and University education. **Pre-elementary:** This level is not compulsory but taken seriously by parents. It is offered by day-care centres, nursery schools and kindergartens. Ages 1-5 years.

Elementary level. Ages 6-11 years. It is free and compulsory in all states. Caters for basic education needs like reading, playing in groups, and development of desirable social attitude. Common method of teaching is the democratic approach. No national examinations.

Junior and Senior high school. Takes 6 Years for grades 7& 9 and is also free and compulsory. Senior high school is also free but learners meet the cost of books. At this level, students can either sit for a General Equivalence Diploma (GEP) which is the entry requirement for a 2-year college programme. Alternatively, one can sit for a standard academic test (SAT) which is the entry requirement to university without going the 2-year college.

Higher Education

Comprises of a 2-year college and university education. The 2 years course focuses on general studies in humanities, basic arts, English, Maths and computer science. This is followed by a 2-year senior college course. Alternatively, one can go for a 4-year university undergraduate programme. A master's degree takes 2 years while a doctorate takes 3 years. Most American students obtain their PhDs at age 25.

Administration

- Education in US is highly decentralised as per the constitution.
- Education is administered at 3 levels namely federal, state and local levels.

Financing.

- Elementary education is free. The cost is met by the local authorities, the state and the federal government. Property tax is the main source of revenue of supporting education programmes.

Lessons that we can learn

1. Decentralisation of education management.
2. Elite board management. -Members of the boards are well educated and successful individuals.
3. Sight based management of schools. Schools councils composed of professionals.
4. Free compulsory learning.

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5. Democratic approach in education.
6. Less emphasis on examinations.
7. Inclusive education that caters for all.
8. An all graduate teaching force.
9. Philanthropic funding of education.
10. Close link between school and the industries

Education in Cuba

- i. **Spanish** is the main language of instruction owing to Spanish occupation in the 16th Century.
- ii. **Pre-School** – 6 months to 5 years. It encompasses Day Care Centres and non-formal PreSchools.
- iii. **Primary School**- Grades 1-4 and Grades 5-6 (Ages 6-11) and compulsory. iv. **Secondary Education** has two levels: (a) Lower Secondary- Grades 7-9 (Ages 12-14 years). (b) Upper Secondary School – Grades 10-12 (Ages 15-18 years old).
- v. **University Education** – The 1962 University Reform Bill declared University Education free. By 2018, Cuba had 47 Universities with over 400,000 student enrolment. Marxist-Leninist ideological courses are mandatory; compulsory military service, pass college entrance examinations, compulsory productive work for students, obtain political clearance.
- vi. **Teacher Education**- Pre- service lasts for five years. There is emphasis on manual labour and child centered education; continuous evaluation through action, research and lifelong learning. TTCs are Government controlled to teach a carefully designed and focused national Teachers' curriculum. Teachers are well remunerated. There are special TTCs for helping teachers work in challenging environments.
- vii. **Technical/Vocational Education**- Over 50% of Grade leavers (Lower Secondary) and Grades 10-12 not joining Universities join elementary school TTCs and vocational institutions. These prepare them for jobs in the industrial and agricultural sectors.
- viii. **Special Education**- Available at Pre-school, Primary and Lower Secondary. Cuba prefers Specialized Institutions rather than integration with others. By the year 2000, there were over 400 Special Education Centers with over 57,000 children enrolled.
- ix. **Adult Education** – For workers and farmers on part time basis. They can join the university from Adult Education Institutions.

Administration and Financing- Education is financed by the Central Government since the 1959 Fidel Castro led Revolution. Cuba averagely devotes 9% of GDP to education (2016) placing it 9th in the world (UNESCO recommends at least 6% of GDP on education). Reform decisions are made by the ruling Communist Party. Education is administered under two ministries since 1976: Ministry of Education and Ministry of Higher Education

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Education in Tanzania Education structure

- Structure of education: 2 + 7 + 4 + 2 + 3: years allocated to pre-primary, primary, ordinary secondary, advanced secondary and higher education.

Pre-primary

Mainly provided by private agencies, 2 years

Provided in child care centers, nursery schools, Montessori/other preschools and pre-primary classes affiliated to primary schools.

Provide education and care for children below five years.

Largely regarded as a preparation for primary education and the curriculum focuses on the development of literacy and numeracy skills while social and emotional skills tend to be neglected

Primary Education

- Tanzanian Primary School pupils are taught in their native language of Kiswahili.
- Students begin standard one at age 7 and start learning English in standard 3.
- In 1972 all primary school fees were abolished.
- In Jan 2002 FPE was re-introduced
- The govt abolished primary school fees

Primary education is divided into 2 stages

- Kiswahili is a medium of instruction & also taught as a subject
- English is taught from grade 3 onwards
- Standard I-II: main goal is to develop competencies in the 3Rs. In these years, the curriculum focuses on developing competencies in Reading, Writing and Arithmetics (the 3Rs) among pupils.
- This section is prepared considering that the early years of learning are very crucial for mental, physical & social development of a child.
- For Standards III –VII: Kiswahili, English, Mathematics, Civic and Moral Education, Science and Technology, Social Studies, Vocational Skills and optional subjects (French and Arabic). Nonetheless, at this stage, competencies in the 3Rs will still be emphasized in all subjects.
- Education for production is an fundamental part of the school curriculum
- At the end pupils sit for the primary school leaving certificate
- Challenges: The long distance to school for many students, many responsibilities at home, poor health and funding, prevent many children from attending primary school.

Secondary education

- This level is also divided into 2
- Lower secondary, 4 years which culminates in the certificate of secondary education □
Upper secondary forms 5 and six- Advanced level certificate of secondary education
- Admission to a level is a good pass at form four
- Political education is compulsory
- A level gives admission to university

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- Students who fail form 4 or form 6 exams may go onto an Advanced Vocational School and can train to be a head primary School teacher among other things

Higher Education

- Mainly provided by universities
- Offer both undergraduate and post graduate courses
- Many of them face high unemployment or joblessness
- Serious difficulties in getting a firm foothold into the labor market.
- Many leave school without the requisite skills or competences needed in today's economy and society.
- The Ministry of Education, Science, Technology and Vocational Training is responsible for the provision of education, supervision, vocational training and policy on science and technology

Teacher Education

Primary teacher education is based on form four qualification

- This takes 2 years in TTCs. These teachers are graded as follows:
- Grade A- Qualifies to teach all subjects in primary
- Grade B is obtained on promotion or by successfully completing 4 year course at a TTC
- Grade C teachers possess certificates and are qualified to teach the first two grades of primary education

Secondary school teachers are of two categories: Those who hold diplomas and are trained at the national college of education for 2 years after obtaining ASCE.

- Entitles them to teach lower secondary school
- Teachers for upper secondary-must have either a B.Ed or PGDE & are trained at universities

Educational Philosophy

Education for Self-Reliance (ESR) means delivering knowledge about 'self-reliance'.

According to Nyerere, the policy of self-reliance meant that Tanzanian's development should depend on her natural resources.

The concept of Education for Self Reliance is also about self-confidence, independence, responsibility and democratic involvement.

According to Nyerere's viewpoint ESR, is a practical oriented education meant to provide real solutions to the societal needs.

This kind of education is about work by everyone and exploitation by none-sharing of the resources which are produced by fellow humans.

ESR- must set people free in order to encourage the citizens to rely upon their own developments and realize their full potentials.

The educated individuals should serve the masses; they must also realize and recognize themselves as being part of the society. Thus

- education should be relevant to the society
- the educated should serve the society
- educated individuals should be integrated with society

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- education should be problem solving
- education should be work oriented

Challenges that are being faced by the teacher in implementing of the CBC

It should be noted that in the implementation of CBC, the teacher has faced many problems since the 1970s when the approach came up in the United States of America. The problems are crosscutting especially in African countries that have implemented the curriculum like Tanzania, Zambia, Rwanda, Botswana, Senegal, South Africa and Kenya.

Kenyan context.

- a) By the time of roll out, very few teachers had been trained and many who had undergone the training seemed to claim that they still did not know how to implement the CBC.
- b) CBC generally requires small classes for teachers to give personal attention to each learner. However, with increased enrolment to meet the 100% transition, the classrooms were overflowing with large numbers of pupil's hence acute shortage of teachers posed a major challenge in successful implementation of the new curriculum.
- c) Teacher training sessions were largely infective due to; overload of the training sessions which were on the whole quite inadequate, incompetent trainers/facilitators who had not properly conceptualized and understood the CBC, lesson plan and scheme of work were too lengthy which entailed too much preparation and paperwork and took more time at the expense of teaching time, lack of adequate training materials and inadequate information on the new curriculum, and Teachers Service Commission (TSC) transfer of the only CBC trained teachers in a school to other school leaving the school with none or less trained teachers.
- d) Teachers found it difficult to assess learning progress. Assessment Rubrics had unclear guidelines which makes giving learners assessment difficult.
- e) Inadequate infrastructure due to extremely high enrolment. There is lack of permanent classrooms, desks and chairs for teachers and learners. For lower classes, teaching and learning is done under tree/shade in some schools. No braille materials.
- f) Serious problem with distribution and delivery of text books, learning print and digital materials. This had been delayed with schools starting implementation without necessary textbooks. This problem was further compounded by the fact that text books were not available in the market or bookshops. Examples of textbooks that were lacking included; Teachers hand book on the CBC implementation, approved pupils course books e.g. Literacy activities books, Kenya sign language books, approved hygiene and nutrition activities books, play materials and creative activities books.
- g) Poorly printed books owing to hurried implementation of the curriculum which overstretched the writers and publishing houses resulted in unedited books or poorly printed books.

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- h) Syllabus for learners with special needs had not been distributed to schools while there was no syllabus for mentally challenged learners thus diversity of learners with special needs was not catered for.
- i) Lack of shareholders' involvement in the CBC roll out. General lack of parental involvement in the CBC implementation leading to uncooperative parents partly due to the fact that majority of the schools have not inducted parents. Parental and community involvement in the learning process can improve students' behaviour and participation in classroom.

Brain Drain

Define Brain Drain

Read about causes of Brain Drain (Push and Pull factors)

Effects of brain drain –Remember to give illustrations

- i. Shortage of professionals in donor countries. ii. Capital loss- those who go out do not pay taxes in their countries. Those left behind are forced to pay more taxes to take care of various sectors of economy.
- iii. Loss of future leaders.
- iv. Brain drain affects one's patriotism e.g. the issue of one's allegiance to two countries/Miguna Miguna
- v. Some of the professionals come back with high technologies that are useless (can't apply) in their home country
- vi. Benefits the recipient countries who receive the best brains e.g American and Britain
Or any other relevant point.

(b) How African countries can deal with “brain drain”

The candidate is supposed to discuss solutions to “Brain drain” as follows:

- i. Raising salaries and improving working conditions. Third world governments should offer higher salaries for their citizens according to their qualifications instead of estimating and hiring expatriates which is costlier.
- ii. Job guarantee. The governments should guarantee jobs for those who might return home and also recruiting abroad for important public positions for example Korean government successfully lured back Korea scientists trained abroad. iii. Improving political climate/good governance at the national and international level. Good governance and transparency in leadership is essential and should be maintained. In political distressed countries professionals may be relocated to safer places where they are likely to be productive. In case of political turmoil, a change in political set

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up is necessary as it happened in Jamaica in 1975 and in Nigeria in 1997 and this may encourage migrants to return.

- iv. Economic incentives-Governments should encourage economic incentives on selective basis for example the government of Sri Lanka launched a programme in 1979 to encourage professionals to stay or return home by revising its pension system, easing exchange controls so that people could finance their education of their children at home
- v. Restrictive policies aimed at delaying emigration such as imposing heavy emigration taxes and passport fees on trained manpower. Also introducing compulsory public service employment for certain categories of professionals.
- vi. Tax proposals-Governments should realize that the large numbers of citizens living outside their borders are potential economic resources. For example, Zimbabwe has proposed that graduates who received state assistance are required to surrender 1/3 of their salaries if they choose to work in foreign countries on completion of their studies.
- vii. International agreements. Industrialized and developing nations should adopt a strategy/policy not to recruit people from developing countries but rather develop and adapt a strategy that involves transferring of skills through networks of professionals and intellectuals and time- tested approach of repatriation. Or any other relevant point

HIGHER EDUCATION IN AFRICA: A COMPARATIVE PERSPECTIVE

Specific objectives

- a. Define the word higher education
- b. Discuss the development of higher education in Africa
- c. Highlight some solutions of the challenges facing higher education

Definition of “Higher Education”

- It can be used to refer to a wide variety of non-university and university post-secondary institutions, which act as avenues for advanced skills and knowledge development. These include universities, colleges, institutes and higher vocational and professional institutions.

DEVELOPMENT OF HIGHER EDUCATION IN AFRICA

- University/Higher education in Africa is relatively new.
- Attempts to develop higher institutions in both English and French speaking countries of Africa started after the WW2
- These institutions were deliberately modelled on the universities in France and England i.e. emulated former colonial powers institutions in terms of curricular content.

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- In British colonies, the university colleges in special relation with university of London under the supervision of the inter-university council for higher education in the colonies.
- In French colonies, universities were established under a decree of the French Ministry of National Education creating French Universities overseas.
- The decree specified that the universities were to be governed by the statutes which governed other universities in France.
- In a nut shell, it may be observed that colonial higher education institutions were established to promote cultural superiority of the colonial powers in Africa.
- At independence, universities were among other roles expected to produce highly skilled manpower so as to transform socially and economically the new nations.
- Though university education has developed significantly since independence, the relevance of some degree programmes is doubtful and has increasingly drawn criticism.
- Universities have failed to adapt to a large extent to the African environment

CHALLENGES FACING HIGHER EDUCATION IN AFRICA

- I. The enrolment rate in higher education in Sub-Saharan Africa are by far the lowest in the world.
 - ❖ Enrolments growth rates have been low and the absolute gap by which it lags behind other regions has increased rapidly.
 - ❖ Gender disparity has traditionally been wide and remain so.
 - ❖ However, increased awareness of the potential and necessity of women to be mainstreamed into the development process, their access to higher education has increases marginally since 1980.
- II. Acute shortage of employment opportunities in most African countries.
 - This is attributed to weak links between the industry and the universities. This is further compounded by weak curriculum that stresses theory rather than the skills competences leading to massive graduates' unemployment
 - This is due to mismatch between educational programmes offered and the needs of the labour market and the prevailing trade and investment strategies eg Mozambique reports few places for students and poor quality of the courses.
- III. Poverty
 - Has affected higher education in various ways:
 - Malawi-inadequate boarding facilities
 - Mauritania-overcrowding in campuses
 - S. Africa-Lack of funding is a major and state sponsored financial assistance to students has gone decreasing. Eligible but financially needy students continue to be excluded from S. Africa higher education. More than 1600 students failed to access government funds in 2009.
 - In Kenya-lack of funds has affected the admission of new students.

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The new proposal by the government of reducing funding to the universities is expected to worsen the situation if implemented.

IV. Laws/Legislation

- ✚ In some countries, laws/legislation often hamper efforts to increase higher education enrolments and improve teaching quality.
- ✚ In other countries, highly centralized policy making on Higher Education restricts the autonomy of universities to be responsive to changes in knowledge, labor market and economic development.
- ✚ In other countries, lack of centralization and system oversight allow mushrooming of private universities that provide low quality education at high cost.
- ✚ In comparative perspective TZ, Cameroon and Madagascar are examples of countries where governments supervise many aspects of university operations.
- ✚ In Angola, Guinea and Liberia the public institutions are allowed legal autonomy and even encouraged the establishment of private institutions.
- ✚ In Kenya there are laid down steps in the registration of private university to recognition and accreditation

V. Quality of Education

The following compromise the quality of education: inadequate mastery of education programmes, the application of rigid teaching practices, lack of teaching/learning materials and insufficient teaching time.

- Among the reasons that could explain the inadequate learning outcomes in the region are shortages of teachers, resulting in overcrowded classes with learners' ratio that can be as high as 70:1 or even 100:1.
- Lecture halls are overcrowded, while laboratories and library facilities are insufficient and the living conditions are precarious.
- Rapid increase in enrollment in H.E institutions has led to decline in quality since it is not matched with commensurate increase in funding. In addition, some of the private higher education institutions being established are profit oriented with little regard to quality.
- There is poor preparation of students at lower levels, leading to low internal and external inefficiencies at higher education levels. This further impact on the insufficient development of the country, poverty reduction and lack of improvement of other levels of education system.
- The use of ICT continues to be relatively low.
- Academically the higher education institutions are unable to cope with the new changes that are global and technological. Moreover, the individual scholars are not able to embrace new ICT skills required in their teaching. This further compounded by inadequate training and research conditions and low scholarly incentives, there is a strong temptation for many among the brightest students and teaching staff to seek better living conditions in other countries and regions.

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- There is the challenge of rising demand and access and the struggle to raise and maintain quality and relevance. This can be attributed to slow response to change, inadequate financial resources to expand facilities that affect access.
- HIV/AIDS is manifesting itself in lowering of the quality as a result of the deterioration of educational provision and of education system, the psychological conditions faced by both teachers and students and declining capacity for planning and management e.g in 2004, over 40% of teachers in Zambia were HIV positive-high magnitude of the problem the education sector has to contend with. VI. Brain Drain.

VII. Competition

- H.E has become more competitive, especially given the increasing private sector participation, increasing demand for accountability, limited public funding for higher education and the advent of borderless tertiary education.
- Competition in developed world is forcing some institutions to seek new, easy to access markets in developing countries. Some established satellite campuses, or are partnering with local institutions in developing countries to offer their degree programmes in areas that have ready markets e.g business management and information technology.

The student can add any other valid challenges.

SUGGESTED SOLUTIONS

1. Funding.

○ .

2. Regular updating of Knowledge and skills

3. Partnership/Collaboration with other universities.

- ✓ The development of domestic graduate education programs as the solution for training future academic staff to PhD level.
- ✓ For initial period, this may require strong partnership with other universities (both in south and north) as capacity for local research and supervision is likely to be limited.
- ✓ Staff retention: There is need to create favorable climate for staff retention by addressing the concerns, changing the approach to staff training and allowing staff to use their skills in a transparent and well managed manner to supplement their income.
- ✓ Regional collaboration helps to achieve economies of scale, especially for capital intensive and highly specialized disciplines in the sciences, engineering and medicine.
- ✓ In addition, maintaining adequate levels of educational quality and relevance requires active and sustainable access to global knowledge through professional interchanges, library resources or joint research opportunities.

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4. HIV/AIDS Policy

- The government of Botswana has embarked on a major policy decision taken within the health sector that cushions the impact of the HIV/AIDS pandemic in the provision of free Anti-Retroviral Therapy to all citizens. This has helped in retaining teaching force in all sectors of education system.
- Another policy issue involves infusion/integration of HIV/AIDS education into the curriculum.
- Further, the policy has prescribed the incorporation of guidance and counselling into teacher training programmes and discouraged discrimination against those children and teachers infected or affected by the condition. They are allowed to stay in school regardless of the status.
- The experience with Botswana can provide a good lesson for other countries in Sub-Saharan Africa where the teaching population continues to be decimated by HIV/AIDS. Not many countries can afford free ARVs for their citizens.

The student needs to add more solutions to the additional challenges cited above.

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